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BAGONG PILIPINAS

CC 101 – Introduction to Computing

Laboratory Worksheet No. 1 | Week 3: Computer Components I – Hardware (CO2)

"Know Your Machine": Exploring the Computer Unit You Are Using

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Computer Unit Used (Desktop/Laptop, brand): Desktop	**Date:** September 16 2026

I. Objectives

At the end of this activity, you should be able to:

- Identify the major hardware components of the computer unit you are using and describe the function of each.
- Use built-in Windows 11 tools to inspect and record your computer's technical specifications.
- Distinguish between input, output, processing, and storage devices on an actual working computer.
- Document your exploration accurately and reflect on what you learned.

II. Materials Needed

- A computer unit running Windows 11 (school laboratory PC or personal laptop/desktop)
- This worksheet (printed copy, or the digital file to fill out and submit)
- Optional: smartphone camera, to photograph the physical unit and ports for your own reference

III. Background

Every computer, whether a desktop tower or a laptop, is built from hardware components that fall into four general categories: input devices (send data into the computer, e.g., keyboard, mouse), output devices (present processed data to the user, e.g., monitor, speakers), the processing/storage unit (CPU, RAM, and drives that compute and hold data), and ports/peripherals (connectors that link external devices to the system unit). Windows 11 also provides several built-in tools — Settings, System Information, Device Manager, and Task Manager — that let you inspect these components without opening the case. This activity uses both direct observation and these software tools.

IV. Procedure

Part A – Physical Inspection (5–10 minutes)

1. Examine the computer unit in front of you. If it is a desktop, look at the system unit (tower/case); if it is a laptop, examine the whole chassis.
2. List all the input devices you can see or that are built in (e.g., keyboard, mouse, touchpad, webcam, microphone).
3. List all the output devices you can see or that are built in (e.g., monitor/screen, speakers, headphone jack).
4. Locate the available ports on the unit (USB-A, USB-C, HDMI, audio jack, Ethernet/LAN, power, etc.) and note what each one is typically used to connect.

Part B – System Identification (Settings)

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5. Click Start → Settings → System → About.
6. Record the Device name, Processor, Installed RAM, Device ID, and System type shown under Device specifications.
7. Scroll down to Windows specifications and record the Edition, Version, and OS build.

Part C – Detailed Hardware Check (System Information)

8. Press the Windows key, type System Information, and open it (this runs the msinfo32 tool).
9. On the System Summary page, record the System Manufacturer, System Model, BIOS Version/Date, and Total Physical Memory.

Part D – Device Manager Exploration

10. Right-click the Start button and choose Device Manager.
11. Expand at least six (6) categories — for example: Display adapters, Network adapters, Sound/video/game controllers, Disk drives, Keyboards, Mice and other pointing devices, and Universal Serial Bus controllers.
12. For each category you expand, write down the specific device name Windows lists (this is the exact model of that component in your unit).

Part E – Performance and Storage Check (Task Manager)

13. Open Task Manager (Ctrl + Shift + Esc) and click the Performance tab.
14. Record the CPU name, base speed, and number of cores; the total Memory (RAM) and its speed; and the Disk type (HDD or SSD) and capacity.

Part F – Software Snapshot (Optional / Bonus)

15. Go to Settings → Apps → Installed apps. List five (5) installed applications and classify each as System Software or Application Software.

V. Data and Findings

Table 1. System Identification Summary (Parts B & C)

Item	Your Findings
Device name	DESKTOP-4MKSC1R
Processor	12th Gen Intel(R) Core(TM) i5-12400 2.50 GHz
Installed RAM	16.0 GB (15.8 GB usable)
Device ID	635A5817-6B5D-4DD7-BDB1-0BD91DB6852E
System type (32-bit / 64-bit)	64-bit operating system, x64-based processor
Windows edition	Windows 10 Pro
Windows version	22H2
OS build	19045.5011

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Item	Your Findings
System manufacturer	Micro-Star International Co., Ltd.
System model	MS-7D48
BIOS version / date	American Megatrends International, LLC. A.E0, 1/11/2024
Total physical memory	15.8GB

Table 2. Physical Components Observed (Part A)

Component Observed	Type (Input/Output/Storage/Processing/Port)	Description / Observation
Mouse	Input	Used to click and navigate the screen
Monitor	Output	Display videos, text and images
keyboard	Input	Used for typings words and numbers
CPU	Processing	The CPU is used to process instructions and perform tasks on the computer. It helps run programs, apps, and other operations.
Headset port	Port	Used to connect a headset or headphones for audio input and output.
Audio port	Port	Used to connect speakers, microphones, or other audio devices.
USB port	Port	Used to connect devices like keyboards, mice, flash drives, and other USB devices.
Cooling fan	processing	Keeps the CPU and other components cool and prevents overheating.
Motherboard	processing	Connects all the computer components and allows them to communicate with each other.

Table 3. Device Manager Findings (Part D)

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Device Manager Category	Specific Device Name Listed
Display adapters	Intel(R) UHD Graphics 730
Network adapters	Realtek PCIe GbE Family Controller VirtualBox Host-Only Ethernet Adapter Wan Miniport (IKEv2) Wan Miniport (IP) Wan Miniport (IPv6) Wan Miniport (L2TP) Wan Miniport (Network Monitor) Wan Miniport (PPOE) Wan Miniport (PPTP) Wan Miniport (SSTP)
Sound, video and game controllers	HD Audio Driver for Display Audio HD Audio Driver for Display Audio High Definition Audio Device
Disk drives	TEAM T253256GB
Keyboards	HID Keyboard Device
Mice and other pointing devices	HID-compliant mouse
Universal Serial Bus controllers	Generic USB Hub Intel(R) USB 3.20 eXtensible Host Controller - 1.20 (Microsoft) USB Composite Device USB Root Hub (USB 3.0)

Table 4. Software Snapshot (Part F, Optional / Bonus)

Installed Application	Classification (System / Application Software)

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Installed Application	Classification (System / Application Software)

VI. Realization (Reflection)

In two to four sentences each, answer the following in your own words.

1. What did you discover about your own computer unit that you did not know before doing this activity?

I discovered more about my own computer unit while doing this activity. I learned the different names and parts that I usually see but didn't really know much about before. I also learned what the Device Manager is and what I can find inside it. This activity helped me understand my computer better and know more about how its components work.

2. Which hardware component do you think matters most to how your computer performs, and why?

I think the CPU or processor matters the most because it helps my computer run and process different tasks. If the CPU is good, the computer can work faster and handle programs better. I noticed that it plays a big part in making the computer run smoothly. That's why I think the CPU is one of the most important parts of a computer.

3. How might knowing your computer's hardware and software specifications help you as a future IT/CS professional?

Knowing my computer's hardware and software specifications can help me understand how a computer works. It can also help me choose the right programs and know if my computer can handle them. As a future IT/CS professional, this knowledge can help me troubleshoot problems more easily.

4. What difficulties, if any, did you encounter while completing this activity, and how did you resolve them?

One difficulty I had was finding some of the information about my computer. At first, I didn't know where to look for some of the details. I solved it by checking the settings and searching to see if I could find them there. After looking around my computer, I was able to find the information I needed

VII. Scoring Guide

Criteria	Description	Points
Completeness	All tables (1–4) and required fields are filled out.	30
Accuracy	Recorded specifications and device names match what the tools actually show.	30

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Criteria	Description	Points
Realization / Reflection	Answers are thoughtful, specific to the student's own unit, and well written.	30
Neatness & Timeliness	Worksheet is legible/well-formatted and submitted on time.	10
Total		**100**

Checked by: **Score:** / 100

Instructor's Signature over Printed Name / Date

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